

NOT HERE — The Sixth Bar: Audition Brief

Three candidate variants for the Act 3 composition finale · prepared for the listening session required by design/act3-plan.md §Cues, item 1 — no scene prose hardens around a variant until it is approved.

Where this sits

The Foghorn Song is six bars in D dorian, 6/8; bar 6 has always been a rest. Bar 5 — Sam's run — ends hanging on **E, the 2nd degree**, over Barb's Am chord: it wants D and has never got it. In the finale the player composes the sixth bar, and the no-key game selects the notated variant by the Night-1 intake answer (n1: goodbye) — the interview literally composes your bar. Per Ruling 3, the only sixth bar ever rendered in any ending is the player's; Wren's own ending stays unheard. Each candidate renders solo on guitar and in context — bars 1–5 as shipped, the candidate answering in bar 6 over the sea and the horn's low D drone.

The three candidate sixth bars, each shown after bar 5's hanging E

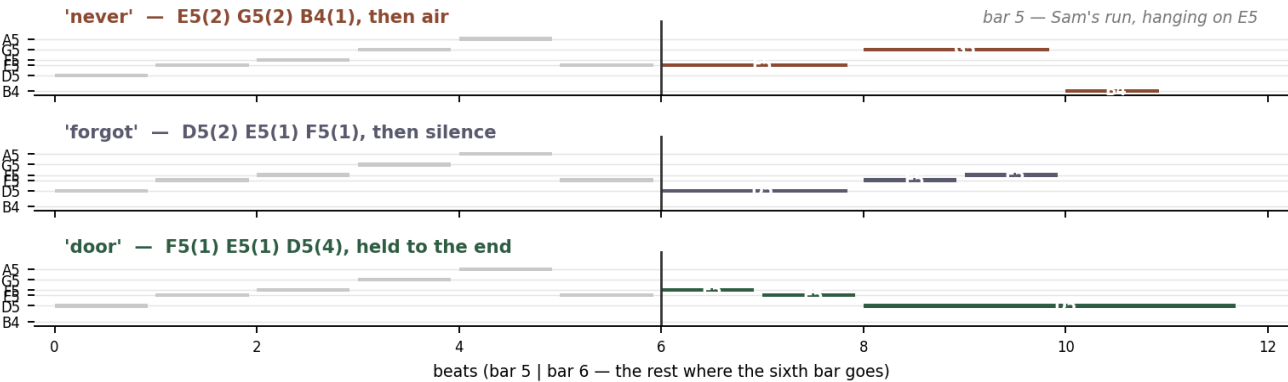


Figure 1 — Pitch content of each candidate (coloured) following bar 5 (grey). Beats are eighth notes; the bar line marks the rest where the sixth bar goes.

The candidates side by side

Variant	Night-1 answer	What the bar does	Dramatic reading	Audition files
'door'	"I said it to the door."	F5–E5–D5 held four beats. The only variant that resolves: it finishes bar 1's D–E–F–E arch with the first D the melody has ever been given.	You said goodbye to something, once. Your bar gets to cadence — completion as self-erasure; the gift that only costs everything.	sixthbar-door.wav (5.9 s) sixthbar-door-context.wav (28.5 s)
'never'	"No. I never do."	E5–G5–B4, then air. Climbs the ii triad — the chord that most wants to lead home — and abandons it on the dorian question-note. No D anywhere; no cadence.	For the one who never says goodbye: the bar ends without cadence, with air left in it — the same refusal the horn has made for seven years.	sixthbar-never.wav (5.9 s) sixthbar-never-context.wav (28.5 s)
'forgot'	"I don't remember leaving it."	D5–E5–F5, then two silent beats. Quotes bar 1's opening at pitch, then the memory fails on its peak note — the F cut to a single fading beat, and nothing after.	For the one who can't remember leaving: the tune starts to come back and doesn't. The break is the biography.	sixthbar-forgot.wav (5.9 s) sixthbar-forgot-context.wav (28.5 s)

What to listen for

- 1. The hand-off.** In each context render, bar 5's hanging E should feel like a question the candidate answers — or pointedly refuses to. 'door' should land like a held breath let go; 'never' like a sentence interrupted politely; 'forgot' like a radio losing the station.
- 2. The voice.** The candidate enters on guitar against the town's music box — it should read as *a person answering a music box*, not a new verse of the same tune.
- 3. The drone.** The horn holds its low D under all of bar 6. Only 'door' agrees with it; 'never' and 'forgot' should audibly withhold that agreement.
- 4. Tempo feel.** 144 bpm eighth-note pulse — slow, tidal. If a candidate feels rushed against the sea swells, the fault is the render, not the notes.

Decision requested: approve each variant (or send it back) so Act 3 prose can harden around the selected bars. These three are the complete deterministic fallback under the LLM judge (Ruling 8) — every intake has exactly one bar; the no-key game remains the whole game. Sources: packages/music/scores/sixthbar-candidates.ts and foghorn-song.ts; renders in auditions/.